

Operational Metric Definitions Standard

Tallowbrook Health | Decision Support & Operational Reporting | 2025-02-01

Data Standard DS-02, version 3.0, effective February 1, 2025. Owner: Director, Decision Support & Operational Reporting. Applies to all operational dashboards, the monthly operating review package and department reports that use EDW data.

1. Purpose

This standard gives one definition for each operational metric used across Tallowbrook so that dashboards, operating reviews and department reports produce the same numbers. Reports that use a different definition must label it and explain the difference.

2. Data sources and timing

Metrics are calculated in the enterprise data warehouse (EDW) and published on the Pulse portal. Most dashboards refresh nightly; staffing dashboards refresh after each pay period closes. Figures for the most recent day or pay period may change after late documentation or pay corrections.

3. Inpatient capacity

Inpatient admissions: patients admitted to inpatient status. Observation stays are excluded, including observation patients later converted, who count on the date of the inpatient order.

Patient days: inpatients counted at the midnight census.

Occupancy: midnight census divided by staffed beds. Facility occupancy in the operating review uses inpatient patient days. Unit occupancy on bed management views also counts observation patients in inpatient beds and therefore runs higher.

Average length of stay (ALOS): patient days divided by discharges for the same period.

Staffed beds: beds open and staffed under the approved staffing plan for the period, not licensed beds.

4. Emergency department

ED visits: patients registered in the ED, including those who leave before being seen.

ED boarding hours: time from the inpatient admission order to the time the patient leaves the ED, attributed to the destination unit. This definition has applied since February 2024; earlier reports started the clock at the bed request.

5. Perioperative

Surgical cases: patients who entered an operating room for a scheduled or add-on procedure. Procedure room cases are reported separately.

Block utilization: in-room to out-of-room minutes used within a service's block, divided by allocated block minutes net of time released on schedule under the block policy.

6. Staffing

Planned RN hours: the official staffing grid applied to the actual census for each shift.

Variance: worked hours minus planned hours; positive values mean more hours were worked than planned.

Overtime, float pool and agency percentages: each hour type divided by total worked hours.

7. Equipment maintenance

PM completion: scheduled maintenance work orders completed by their due date divided by scheduled maintenance work orders due in the period. Reported overall, for high-risk devices and by system, and reviewed monthly by the Environment of Care committee.

8. Use in the monthly operating review

The monthly operating review, held on the third Thursday, reports volumes, capacity, staffing, quality and financial results by facility and service line using these definitions. Decision Support prepares the package from the EDW after month-end close.

9. Changes to this standard

Requests to add or change a definition go to Decision Support. Changes take effect at the start of a month and are recorded here. Version 3.0 adds the block utilization and PM completion definitions and clarifies the treatment of observation patients.